

Deaconesses and Lay Ministry Measure 1972

1972 No. 4

A MEASURE passed by the General Synod of the Church of England to enable further provision to be made by Canon with respect to the ministry of deaconesses, licensed lay workers, readers and other lay persons. [9th August 1972]

1.—(1) It shall be lawful for the General Synod to provide by Canon for the authorisation by the bishop of the diocese of deaconesses, licensed lay workers, readers, and other lay persons having such qualifications as may be prescribed by Canon, to perform any of the following duties at the invitation of the minister of a parish or an extra-parochial minister:—

Provision for extending the ministry of deaconesses, licensed lay workers, readers and others.

(a) to church women;

(b) in the absence of the minister, to baptise;

(c) with the goodwill of the persons responsible, to bury the dead or read the burial service before, at or after a cremation.

(2) A Canon made in pursuance of the preceding subsection may provide for substituting, when a cure is vacant, the invitation of the rural dean for the invitation of the minister of the parish or parishes concerned.

(3) The power to provide by Canon for the matters aforesaid shall be exerciseable notwithstanding any rubric or direction in the Book of Common Prayer or any rule of ecclesiastical law.

(4) References in any enactment or Measure relating to burial or cremation to a clerk or minister in Holy Orders, or to qualified persons authorised by an incumbent or minister, or to a minister of religion, shall be construed as including references to a person authorised in pursuance of subsection (1) of this section to perform the duties specified in paragraph (c) thereof, but not so as to enable any such person to perform those duties otherwise than in accordance with the conditions prescribed by Canon.

1967 No. 2. (5) In this section the expression "extra-parochial minister" means a minister licensed under section 2 of the Extra-Parochial Ministry Measure 1967 to perform at any of the institutions therein mentioned all or any of the duties specified in subsection (1) of this section.

Short title
and extent. 2.—(1) This Measure may be cited as the Deaconesses and Lay Ministry Measure 1972.

(2) This Measure shall extend to the whole of the Provinces of Canterbury and York except the Channel Islands:

Provided that this Measure may be applied to the Channel Islands as defined in the Channel Islands (Church Legislation) Measures 1931 and 1957, or either of them, in accordance with those Measures.